

Apart from these standard software, today there are a wide variety of programs meant for the common user – who is not necessarily a budding photographer in the making but is looking to make his everyday phone or digicam pictures more dramatic and stylized. The most popular on-the-go program that you can use without any tutorial is probably Picasa. The photo viewer is a common option today and the ease with which it allows you to re-touch your images has made it one of the most widely used programs for such an audience. What adds to the popularity is the ease with which you can sync up all your local folders in the app with the Picasa Web Albums online and can also blog and tweet from Picasa on the supported platforms like Blogger, WordPress etc.

Software like Picasa are ideal for people who may not necessarily want to go into depths of every effect you apply, but are more interested in basic touch-ups. Almost all options like brightness, color temperature, back ground lighting etc are present in the form of easy to use slider bars with which you can experiment freely and choose a value that suits your desired look, along with options like adding subtle (or not so subtle) effects like sepia, tint, soft focus, filtered black and white etc. It also gives you a quick way to organize your collections and with features like the face recognition option allow you to view people albums at a glance where the software automatically recognizes facial features and if you provide it with the name of a person in a particular image, it will keep updating that album with all new photos of that individual you add. The only major downside is the huge amounts of disk space Picasa eats up.

Online editing options

Similar editing features like this are now widely available online through dedicated sites like Pixlr, phixr, Rollip, PhotoFunia, Picnik, FotoFlexer and many more similar web apps. They allow you to quickly upload pictures and apply adjustments like color, contrast, brightness etc online only, though for obvious reasons you usually undergo a sizeable reduction in size (and related reduction in quality) of the image. Apart from the standard adjustments that you can do, one of the most fun features of these sites are the pre-set effects you can apply on your image like making it look like an oil painting, a comic strip, giving it an aged, vintage, make it a watermark look etc. In Photoshop or Lightroom too you can reach these “looks” but with a lot of careful manipulation as compared to simply uploading a file and picking an option from a list. Then of course there is a gamut of sites